Jerry Shaughnessy

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SUMMARY

Human Factors M.S. student and UX researcher with hands-on experience across the full research cycle, from study design and participant recruitment to synthesis and stakeholder communication. Conducted usability tests, interviews, diary studies, heuristic evaluations, and surveys at KQED and SJSU's XIE Lab, with a focus on accessibility and inclusive design.

EDUCATION

San Jose State University – San Jose, CA *Anticipated December 2027 | GPA: 4.00*
M.S. in Human Factors & Ergonomics

University of California, Santa Cruz – Santa Cruz, CA *June 2024 | GPA: 3.80*
B.S. in Cognitive Science with Honors · B.A. in Psychology with Honors

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Audience Intelligence Research Intern – KQED *July 2026 – Present*

- Conducting member interviews on the value of membership, performing thematic analysis, and presenting findings to 6–8 stakeholders across membership and content teams
- Designing and programming research panel surveys for the audience research team and updating the KQED.org panel page
- Running usability testing, contextual inquiry and a heuristic evaluation of the KQED website to surface friction points in content discovery

Graduate Research Assistant – XIE Lab, SJSU *Oct. 2025 – Present*
XIE Cross Innovation Lab : Dr. Jingyi Xie – HCI/UX

AI-Assisted AAC Device Interface

- Running a 2-week diary study and interviews examining how AI supports self-expression for adults with speech impairments
- Co-leading the literature review on agency and efficiency in AI-assisted AAC
- Prototyping multimodal interaction flows in Figma and overseeing IRB compliance (approved Spring 2026); recruited 10+ participants through outreach to speech-language pathologists and AAC organizations

Multimodal AI Tutoring System

- Synthesizing literature on feedback timing, emotional and behavioral dimension categorization, and adaptive scaffolding strategies to inform the system's AI-driven feedback design
- Recruiting and moderating usability sessions with neurodivergent college students (ADHD, ADD) to evaluate an AI-integrated tutoring application that delivers scaffolded feedback based on real-time emotional and behavioral cues
- Presented both multimodal tutoring and AAC projects at the HFES ASPIRE conference 2026

Undergraduate Research Assistant – UCSC *Sept. 2022 – June 2024*
Spontaneous Communication Lab · Dr. Jean Fox Tree – Psycholinguistics

- Moderated in-person and remote experiments on the liking gap in computer-mediated communication, collected data for a 2025 paper in Computers in Human Behavior Reports, and presented findings at the PSI CHI Symposium 2024

WORK EXPERIENCE

Behavioral Technician – Amergis Healthcare, Santa Cruz, CA *Aug. 2024 – June 2025*

- Provided 1:1 instructional support for a student with severe speech impairments using AAC devices; applied behavioral data collection to improve attendance from ~2 to ~5 days per week

Assistant Baseball Coach – San Lorenzo Valley High School, Felton, CA *Oct. 2024 – June 2025*

- Coached student-athletes in baseball fundamentals and game strategy; provided teaching points during practice and games

LEADERSHIP

Event Director – SJSU HFES Student Chapter *Oct. 2025 – Present*

- Organizing and planning chapter events that connect current students, alumni, and industry professionals within the Human Factors community
- Developing RSVP and feedback surveys to track attendance, gauge interest, and inform future programming
- Designing promotional flyers and outreach materials in Canva to advertise events across student and alumni networks

Co-Founder – UCSC Club Baseball *Sept. 2022 – June 2024*

- Co-founded the club from the ground up, coordinated player recruitment, logistics, and successfully advocated for official affiliation with UCSC

PUBLICATIONS

Kherella, E., Shaughnessy, J., Belleza, F. A., & Xie, J. (2026). Using Artificial Intelligence to Balance Agency and Efficiency in AAC Devices for Speech-Impaired Users. Proc. HFES Annual Meeting. doi:10.1177/10711813261484496

Jung, J., Shaikh, A., Shaughnessy, J., et al. (2026). Adaptive Multimodal AI Tutoring: Using Real-Time Cues to Personalize Feedback and Support Engagement in Learning. Proc. HFES Annual Meeting. doi:10.1177/10711813261485171

SKILLS

Research Methods: Usability Testing · Heuristic Evaluation · Contextual Inquiry · Diary Studies · User Interviews · Thematic Analysis · Survey Design · Experimental Design · Competitive Analysis · User Personas · Task Analysis · Eye Tracking · SUS
Tools: Figma · Great Question · Alchemer · Conjointly · Google Forms · SPSS · Python · R (learning) · Asana · Canva